

# **Constitution of Siyenga Community Empowerment Network**

## **Preamble**

We, the members of the **Siyenga Community Empowerment Network**, establish this constitution to guide our efforts in supporting the welfare and development of our members through financial assistance, social activities, and other supportive initiatives.

## **Article I: Name**

This organization's name shall be **Siyenga Community Empowerment Network**, hereafter referred to as “**Siyenga Community Empowerment Network**.”

## **Article II: Mission Statement**

The Siyenga Community Empowerment Network's mission is to promote its members' welfare by providing financial, social, and personal development support. We aim to foster a sense of community, solidarity, and empowerment among all members.

## **Article III: Vision Statement**

To build a community where every member has the resources, support, and connections needed to thrive, fostering resilience and empowerment for a better future.

## **Article IV: Membership**

### **1. Eligibility**

Membership is open to individuals who:

- ✓ Share the Group’s commitment to welfare and support.
- ✓ Are recommended by a current member (optional).
- ✓ Meet the minimum age requirement of 18 years (optional).

### **2. Registration Fees**

- ✓ A one-time registration fee of ksh 100 is required upon joining the Group.
- ✓ An annual membership fee of ksh 1000 is required to maintain active status.

### **3. Rights and Responsibilities**

- ✓ Members have the right to participate in all Group activities, access support services, and vote on key issues.
- ✓ Members are expected to contribute to Group activities, abide by the constitution, and respect other members.

## **Article V: Code of Conduct**

1. **Respect**

All members must treat each other with respect and courtesy, avoiding any form of discrimination, harassment, or offensive behavior.

2. **Confidentiality**

Members must respect the privacy and confidentiality of other members, particularly in matters discussed within the Group.

3. **Accountability**

Members are accountable to the Group for their actions, especially when representing the Group publicly.

## **Article VI: Scope of Operations**

1. **Financial Assistance**

- ✓ The Group may provide financial assistance to needy members through emergency loans, grants, or savings programs.
- ✓ Requests for assistance will be reviewed by the Welfare Manager and approved by the leadership team based on the availability of funds.

2. **Social Support**

- ✓ The Group will organize social gatherings, networking events, and recreational activities to strengthen bonds among members.

3. **Personal Development**

- ✓ Members will have access to workshops, skill-building sessions, and mentorship programs to aid in personal and professional growth.

## **Article VII: Leadership Structure**

1. **Officers**

The Group's leadership shall consist of the following officers:

- ✓ **Chairperson/President:** Leads the Group, facilitates meetings, and ensures all activities align with the mission.
- ✓ **Vice Chair/Deputy:** Assists the Chairperson and assumes duties in their absence.
- ✓ **Treasurer:** Manages the Group's finances, maintains records, and provides periodic financial reports.(vice)
- ✓ **Secretary:** Records meeting minutes, manages documents, and oversees member communication.(vice)
- ✓ **Welfare Manager:** Identifies member needs, organizes welfare activities, and manages welfare resources.(deputy)

- ✓ **Additional Support Roles:** Creation of additional roles as the group grows, such as event coordinators, wellness advisors, or community liaisons would be prioritized.

## **2. Election of Officers**

- ✓ Officers shall be elected by a majority vote of members in a general meeting held annually.
- ✓ Each officer will serve a term of two year(s) and may be re-elected for consecutive terms.

## **3. Removal of Officers**

- ✓ An officer may be removed from their position by a two-thirds vote of members if they fail to fulfill their duties or violate the Code of Conduct.

# **Article VIII: Financial Guidelines**

## **1. Fundraising and Contributions**

- ✓ The Group shall raise funds through membership fees, donations, and fundraising activities.
- ✓ All funds collected shall be used solely for Group activities and member welfare, with an emphasis on transparency and accountability.

## **2. Budget and Expenditure**

- ✓ The Treasurer shall prepare an annual budget to be reviewed and approved by the leadership team.
  - Expenditures over ksh 25,000 must be approved by a majority of the leadership team.

## **3. Financial Reporting**

- ✓ The Treasurer shall provide a financial report to members on a quarterly basis, detailing income, expenses, and current balances.

# **Article IX: Meetings**

## **1. General Meetings**

- ✓ The Group shall hold a general meeting every month to discuss current issues, upcoming events, and any other matters affecting the Group.
- ✓ The presence of at least 50% of active members shall constitute a quorum for decisions.

## **2. Special Meetings**

- ✓ Special meetings may be called by the Chairperson/president or by request of at least 10% of members for urgent matters.

## **3. Decision-Making Process**

- ✓ Decisions shall be made by a simple majority vote unless otherwise specified.
- ✓ In case of a tie, the Chairperson's vote shall be decisive.

# **Article X: Amendments to the Constitution**

## **1. Proposals**

- ✓ Amendments to this constitution may be proposed by any member.
- ✓ Proposed amendments must be submitted in writing to the President at least two weeks before a general meeting.

## **2. Approval**

- ✓ Amendments shall be approved by a two-thirds vote of members present at the general meeting.

# **Article XI: Dissolution**

## **1. Dissolution of the Group**

- ✓ The Group may be dissolved by a two-thirds vote of all active members.
- ✓ Upon dissolution, any remaining funds shall be donated to a charity chosen by the members or distributed among members as determined by the leadership team.